GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

May 22nd, 2026
*Week 21*
Volume 282, Issue 1236

***Highlights:***

- **Tankers cross.**
- **Brent eases.**
- **Rupee shatters.**
- **Window closes.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

*"Opportunity is missed by most people because it is dressed in overalls and looks like work."*

*- Thomas Edison*

# -- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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## PASSAGE OPENS, WINDOW CLOSES

The Week 20 "stalemate holds" thesis has been materially challenged by the most concrete reopening signal of the war. President Trump stated on May 20 that the United States is "in the final stages of talks with Iran," while satellite tracking data showed three supertankers transiting the Strait of Hormuz, the first such crossings since March. The Trump-Xi summit in Beijing on May 14 and 15 added a further diplomatic layer, with Xi reportedly pushing for Hormuz to reopen, China agreeing to purchase American oil, and Trump telling reporters on Air Force One that he and Xi "agree almost entirely" on the Iran file. Brent crude fell more than 5% on May 20 to USD 105.29, with WTI at USD 99.85.

The structural counterweights remain. ADNOC's CEO said this week that full recovery in Middle Eastern oil flows is unlikely before late 2027, joining Aramco's Nasser in setting a longer rebalancing horizon. OPEC's May monthly report cut its 2026 global demand growth forecast to 1.17 million barrels per day from 1.38 million, citing the conflict's impact on trade flows, while OPEC+ output fell approximately 1.74 million barrels per day in April alone. Iran's Ali Akbar Velayati also warned Washington against reading the current calm as diplomatic victory. The diplomatic motion has reaccelerated. The supply position has not yet followed.

Freight has consolidated, not collapsed. The Baltic Dry Index closed at 3,005 on May 20 after peaking above 3,092 on May 18. The Baltic Capesize Index cooled to 4,880, with daily Capesize earnings at USD 40,760, off prior-week highs near USD 43,000. The Baltic Panamax Index P5TC has been the standout, rallying from USD 20,548 on Monday to USD 22,691 by Friday, while Supramax held broadly stable near USD 19,800 per day and Handysize near USD 15,300. The dry bulk earnings premium has eased from its peak, but remains high enough to keep older bulkers trading rather than beaching.

Currency divergence has widened to its sharpest configuration of the year. The Indian Rupee has decisively broken 96, with USD/INR touching a fresh all-time high of approximately 96.97 on May 21 and the week trading in a 95.71 to 96.97 range. The Turkish Lira has broken to a fresh record of approximately 45.58, surpassing the Week 19 reference of 45.24. The Pakistani Rupee has sustained its counterintuitive firming at approximately 278.63, while the Bangladeshi Taka continues to trade within its established 122.74 to 123.18 band at 122.87. The Dollar Index remains near 100. Detailed country reads follow on pages 2 through 5.

Bangladesh and India April CPI prints both landed this week. Bangladesh rose to 9.04% from 8.71% in March, with transport at 9.31% and housing-utilities at 8.92%. Taka stability appears to have contained the pass-through compared with Pakistan at 10.9% and Turkey at 32.37%. India printed at 3.48% from 3.40%, still comfortably within the RBI's 2% to 6% tolerance band. Approximately one week now separates the sub-continent from the practical closure of the monsoon window. The seven-week arc from Week 15 through Week 21 has produced a configuration in which oil, freight, currencies, inflation, and now diplomacy all point to the same outcome: tonnage is not arriving in time. Three supertankers crossing Hormuz, Trump's "final stages" framing, and China's diplomatic backing represent the strongest reopening signal yet. They arrive with one week left. The passage may open. The window will not.

*GMS market rankings / pricing for week 21 of 2026 are on Page 5.*

# BANGLADESH

## CURRENCY HOLDS, CPI LANDS

*Currency holds.*

Bangladesh enters Week 21 with USD/BDT at approximately 122.87, fully within the 122.74 to 123.18 band that has now defined Q2 in its entirety. The Taka has not breached that range in either direction through the diplomatic whipsaw, Brent's recovery, the May 20 "final stages" headlines, the Indian Rupee's decisive break of 96, or the Turkish Lira's break to 45.58. The Dollar Index remains near 100, and the central bank has continued to absorb proportional Taka pressure without forced devaluation. Foreign exchange reserves of approximately USD 34.12 billion remain the operative buffer. Local steel plate prices have softened to a BDT 66,700 to BDT 67,500 range, with the USD equivalent at approximately USD 543 to USD 549 per ton, reflecting some mill-level easing on the Brent reversal.

*April CPI lands.*

The Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics released the April 2026 CPI at 9.04% year-on-year, up from 8.71% in March, with non-food inflation rising to 9.57% from 9.09%. The composition reflects the war shock pass-through landing in measurable form: transport prices up 9.31% versus 7.47% in March, housing and utilities up 8.92% versus 8.43%, and food and non-alcoholic beverages up 8.39% versus 8.24%. On a monthly basis, prices eased to 0.7% from the five-month high of 0.89% in March. The print is materially below Pakistan's 10.9% and Turkey's 32.37%, validating the Week 20 thesis that Taka stability through the Q2 band would substantially insulate the basket from the Hormuz-driven pass-through that hit the rest of the basin. The shock has reached Chattogram. The magnitude has been contained.

*Window closes.*

The Letter of Credit pipeline has now sustained its cleared operational status for a sixth consecutive week, with Chattogram cash buyers reporting file-to-fund cycles materially shorter than the February reference. The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs at OPL Chattogram enter their tenth week unresolved. The pre-monsoon window has tightened to approximately one week, the operational ceiling for converting demand into executed beachings before yards must slow cycles. The May 20 Brent collapse to USD 105 on the supertanker crossings and the "final stages" framing has lowered the bunker cost floor that had reinforced the trading earnings premium through Weeks 18 to 20. The directional signal to owners is now genuinely mixed for the first time since the war opened. The operational signal to Chattogram is not. The yards still want ships. The owners still hold them. The window closes regardless.

**MARKET SALES REPORTED**

| VESSEL NAME | TYPE | LDT | REPORTED PRICE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Glas Dowr | FPSO | 27,824 | Undisclosed Price ('as is' Karimun Island) |

# INDIA

## RUPEE SHATTERS, CPI CALM

*Rupee shatters.*

USD/INR has broken decisively above 96 to print a fresh all-time high of approximately 96.97 on May 21, surpassing the Week 20 record of 95.71 and the prior intermediate records of 95.27 on May 4 and 94.42 in Week 14. The week traded in a 95.71 to 96.97 range, with closing prints accelerating from 96.5685 on May 19 to 96.71 on May 20, and finally to the 96.97 high on May 21. The Reserve Bank of India's intervention posture remains restrained. The May 20 Brent collapse to USD 105 on the "final stages" framing and the satellite-confirmed supertanker crossings has not translated into proportional rupee strength, suggesting the market views the diplomatic signal as conditional rather than imminent. The rupee is no longer pricing any near-term Hormuz normalisation. It is now pricing the structural transmission to the import bill and the multi-quarter rebalancing horizon that ADNOC and Aramco have both flagged for late 2027.

*CPI Calm.*

India's April 2026 CPI printed at 3.48% year-on-year on May 12, up only 8 basis points from the March 3.40% reading and comfortably within the RBI's 2% to 6% tolerance band for the 2026 to 2031 period. Food inflation printed at 4.20%, while housing came in at 2.15%. The print is the cleanest possible evidence that India's monetary framework has absorbed the war shock more durably than any other sub-continent economy: Pakistan's April CPI was 10.9%, Turkey's 32.37%, and Bangladesh's 9.04%. The new CPI base year of 2024 and the supply-side resilience in food and core services have offset what would otherwise have been a material rupee-driven imported inflation pulse. The currency and the price level are no longer telling the same story. The currency is telling the harder one.

*Supply unchanged.*

Local steel plate prices at Alang traded in an INR 38,800 to INR 39,500 range through the week, with the USD equivalent at approximately USD 400 to USD 408 per ton at the prevailing 96.97 exchange rate, a continued softening from the Week 20 close. India remains the lowest-priced sub-continent destination, with the gap to Pakistan now widening to approximately USD 285 per LDT given the divergent currency moves. The compliance differentiator remains intact: more than 110 yards at Alang continue to hold valid Statements of Compliance. The monsoon window has narrowed to approximately one week. The structural case for an owner to release tonnage to Alang has not improved on the Week 21 evidence. Three supertankers crossing Hormuz has not released the tonnage. The 96.97 rupee record has not released the tonnage. The 3.48% CPI calm has not released the tonnage. Nothing this week has.

**NO MARKET SALES REPORTED**

# PAKISTAN

## RUPEE ANCHORED, POSITION CONSOLIDATES

***Rupee anchored.***

Pakistan's Week 21 has extended the unusual configuration that defined Week 20. While the Indian Rupee broke decisively above 96 to a fresh record of 96.97 and the Turkish Lira broke to a fresh record of 45.58, USD/PKR has held at approximately 278.63 at the interbank level on May 21, essentially unchanged from the Week 20 close of 278.58 and the prior Week 19 close of 279.61. Open-market quotes remain at 278.9 to 279.85. The Pakistani Rupee is now the only sub-continent currency that has not made a new low since the early-April ceasefire, and on a year-to-date basis, the PKR has actually strengthened 1.13% against the dollar. The State Bank's 100 basis point hike to 11.5%, sustained remittance discipline through Eid preparation flows, and reserve management posture have, in combination, converted what was a Week 19 vulnerability into a Week 21 structural advantage.

***Hike works.***

The Week 19 narrative that Pakistan's currency stability advantage had been undermined by the 10.9% April CPI shock has been substantively reversed by the FX market's response to the SBP rate hike. Two operational weeks into the post-hike regime, transmission is supportive rather than destabilising. Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's earlier disclosure that the weekly oil import bill had risen from USD 300 million pre-war to USD 800 million remains the operative external account stress test. The May print, due in early June, will be the first to fully reflect the Brent recovery to USD 107 followed by the May 20 collapse to USD 105. The round-trip in bunker costs has been more material for Pakistan than for any other sub-continent economy given the share of imports routing through Hormuz.

***Position consolidates.***

Local steel plate prices at PKR 195,000 per ton have held the Week 20 step-up, with the USD equivalent at approximately USD 700 per ton on the firmer PKR. Gadani's absolute pricing position remains the firmest of the year, and the gap to India has now widened to approximately USD 285 per LDT given the divergent currency moves. The Gulf proximity premium that defined Weeks 16 through 18, narrowed in Week 19 by the CPI shock, and repaired in Week 20 by the rupee firming, has now consolidated in Week 21 into the basin's most stable structural position. Three HKC-certified yards remain operational, with further certifications in the pipeline. The candidate pool aligned with Gadani's capacity has not contracted. The Week 21 question is whether the diplomatic signal that drove Brent from USD 107 to USD 105 has materially shifted owners' calculations in time for the one-week pre-monsoon window. On current evidence, it has not.

**NO MARKET SALES REPORTED**

# TURKEY

## LIRA BREAKS AGAIN

*Fresh record.*

Turkey enters Week 21 with USD/TRY at approximately 45.58, a fresh record low surpassing the Week 19 to Week 20 reference of 45.24. The week traded in a 45.57 to 45.59 range with notably tight intraday volatility, suggesting continued Central Bank of Turkey intervention to prevent disorderly devaluation rather than to defend the level. The lira is now down approximately 18% over the past 12 months and 2.5% month-to-date. The TCMB's controlled-slide framework continues to operate as designed: the rate of nominal depreciation is being calibrated to absorb the structural inflation differential without triggering the disorderly capital flight that any abrupt break would produce. The framework is functioning. The level it is converging to is not.

*Inflation locked.*

Turkey's April 2026 CPI at 32.37% year-on-year, with monthly inflation at 4.18% versus 1.94% in March, remains the operative reading and continues to define the 2026 trajectory. The three-month disinflation narrative of Q1 is decisively over. Independent estimates remain materially above the official series, with ENAG at 54.62% and Istanbul Chamber data at 37.68%. The TCMB's 16% year-end target is no longer reconcilable. The May print, due in early June, will be the first to capture the Brent round-trip from USD 107 down to USD 105 on the supertanker crossings and the "final stages" framing, but the structural pass-through that drove the April acceleration has not unwound.

*Niche persists.*

At USD 268 to USD 290 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage. The lira's break to 45.58 has firmed Turkish offers in USD-equivalent terms by approximately 0.7% versus the Week 20 level, but not by enough to bridge the gap to Pakistan at USD 445 to USD 480 or Bangladesh at USD 460 to USD 495. The gap to India at USD 420 to USD 425 has, however, narrowed marginally given the rupee's break to 96.97. Turkey's relevance this Q2 remains confined to the EU-regulated tonnage segment where Basel Convention compliance overrides the price differential. The diplomatic motion, supertanker crossings, BDI consolidation, and rupee shock do not change this structurally. Aliaga continues to operate in a different market.

**NO MARKET SALES REPORTED**

# GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

*For Week 21 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.*

| Rank | Location | Sentiment | Dry Bulk USD / LDT | Tankers USD / LDT | Containers USD / LDT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Bangladesh | **Improving** | 460-465 / LDT | 480-485 / LDT | 490-495 / LDT |
| **2** | Pakistan | **Firming** | 445-450 / LDT | 465-470 / LDT | 475-480 / LDT |
| **3** | India | **Softening** | 415-420 / LDT | 435-440 / LDT | 445-450 / LDT |
| **4** | Turkey | **Softening** | 268-270 / LDT | 278-280 / LDT | 288-290 / LDT |

# DID YOU KNOW?

- *Ship recycling at Alang has helped avoid approximately 72.55 million MT of $CO_2$ emissions, equivalent to the annual carbon absorption of around 27.9 million acres of forest.*

- *Over time, ship recycling at Alang has saved approximately 124.5 million barrels of oil, enough to meet India's total crude oil demand for nearly 5 days.*

- *The energy saved by recycling steel from ships handled at Alang is enough to power the entire city of London for more than a year.*

# IMPORTANT DATES

| INDIA | |
|---|---|
| **BANK HOLIDAYS** | **DELIVERY TIDES** |
| May 27 / 28 – Eid al-Adha | May 28 – June 05<br>June 12 – June 20 |

| BANGLADESH | |
|---|---|
| **BANK HOLIDAYS** | **DELIVERY TIDES** |
| May 26 to May 28 – Eid al-Adha | May 31 – June 03<br>June 14 – June 17 |

| BANK HOLIDAYS | |
|---|---|
| **PAKISTAN** | **TURKEY** |
| May 27 to May 29 – Eid al-Adha | May 19 - Commemoration of Atatürk & Youth Day<br>May 27 / 28 – Kurban Bayramı |

## ALANG - Port Position as of May 22, 2026

| No. | VESSEL NAME | LDT | TYPE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|

**No new vessels reported.**

## CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of May 22, 2026

| No. | VESSEL NAME | LDT | TYPE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Jyang | 4,192 | Heavy Load Carrier | *Delivered May 22* |
| 2 | Wantong Summer | 8,196 | Bulk Carrier | *Delivered May 21* |
| 3 | Hun | 7,822 | Wood Chip Cargo | *Delivered May 20* |
| 4 | Hun 1 | 4,997 | Wood Chip Cargo | *Delivered May 20* |
| 5 | Amazing | 7,075 | Bulk Carrier | *Delivered May 20* |
| 6 | Jian Jie | 1,808 | Tanker | *Delivered May 20* |
| 7 | Energia | 19,899 | Bulk Carrier | Arrived May 14 |
| 8 | Speed | 10,348 | Wood Chip Cargo | Arrived May 14 |
| 9 | Gion Maru No. 8 | 485 | Cement Carrier | Arrived May 11 |
| 10 | Frontier | 4,241 | Ro-Ro Cargo | Arrived May 11 |

## GADANI - Port Position as of May 22, 2026

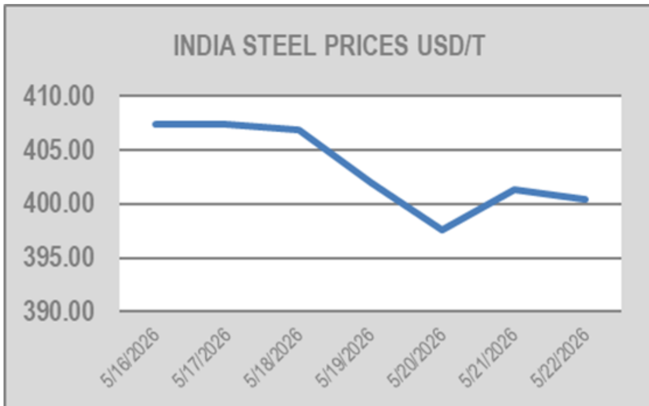
| No. | VESSEL NAME | LDT | TYPE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|

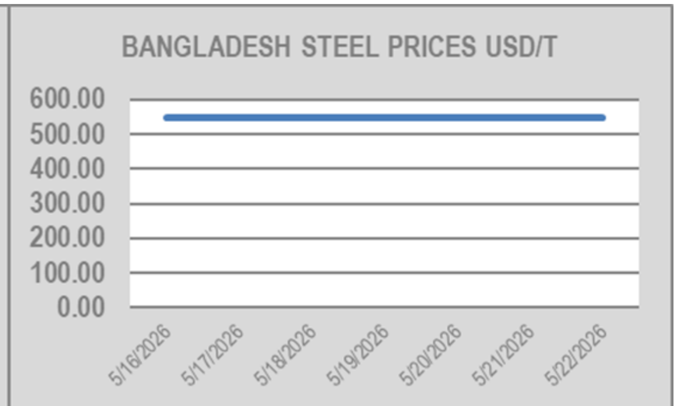
**No new vessels reported.**

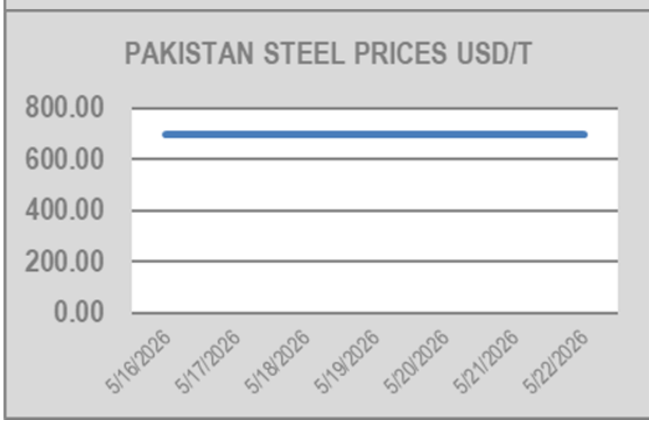
# Steel Plate Prices

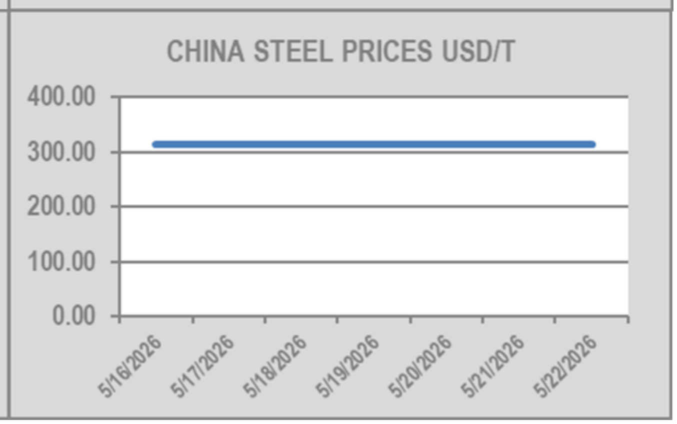


| DATE | INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T | INDIA STEEL PRICES | PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T | PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES | BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T | BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES | CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5/16/2026 | 407.46 | 39,100.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/17/2026 | 407.46 | 39,100.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/18/2026 | 406.85 | 39,200.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/19/2026 | 401.99 | 38,800.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/20/2026 | 397.65 | 38,500.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/21/2026 | 401.29 | 38,600.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |
| 5/22/2026 | 400.42 | 38,500.00 | 696.43 | 195,000.00 | 548.97 | 66,700.00 | 314.66 |

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